coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 1
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artistic Equivalents
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras

- ✓ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Moons and Surfaces
  Reading • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Surface, Scale, Technology
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen

- ✓ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Photographs by NASA
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon

- ✓ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Moon Phases
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
  Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 3
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality

- ✓ Facts and Fictions
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Fictions and Facts
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977
  Video • 4 min
- ✓ Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996
  Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures

- ✓ Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks
  Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967

- ✓ Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand
  Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ✓ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction

- ○ **Introduction to Module 4**
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
  Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books

- ○ Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900
  Reading • 2 min
- ○ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Photo Books
  Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work

- ○ Photo Series
  Reading • 13 min
- ○ Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
  Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many

- ○ One from Many
  Reading • 8 min
- ○ Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
  Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Optional Mid-Course Survey
  Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Introduction to Module 4

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One and Another

Photography is a mechanical process. One consequence of this is that the multiplicity of images has been essential to the medium from its earliest days. Photographers can make multiple prints from a given negative, and can edit groups of images into series. Photographs can be gathered into albums and sequenced in books, and new meanings often emerge from these combinations. Technological advances have repeatedly facilitated the ease and speed with which photographers can produce multiple images, and the artistic possibilities have multiplied alongside them.

A photograph can be a singular, independent object, but what new possibilities and meanings occur when images are paired or combined? This week, we will explore the different ways artists have taken advantage of photography's capacity for multiplicity—by weaving pictures together in photo books and albums; by grouping images to create a series or body of work; and by investigating the ways multiple images can be combined into new, indivisible works.

Learning Objectives

- Analyze the impact of photography's reproducibility.
- Understand how photographs have been combined throughout the medium's history to offer alternative approaches to individual images.
- Consider how albums and books have expanded and facilitated access to photographs and photographic imagery.

Mark as completed

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